IMPACT OF TOTAL QUALITY MANAGEMENT ON EMPLOYEE'S CAREER ADAPTABILITY: A CASE STUDY IN ICESTAR ICE CREAM FACTORY

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Abstract

This study aims to explore the relationship between Total Quality Management (TQM) practices and employee career adaptability within the IceStar Ice Cream factory unit in Sulaymaniyah, Kurdistan Region of Iraq. A quantitative research design was employed, with data collected through a printed survey distributed to a stratified random sample of 75 employees across various departments, including production, quality control, human resources, and logistics. The survey included validated scales measuring five dimensions of TQM leadership, strategy, people, processes, and resource partnerships and four dimensions of career adaptability concern, control, curiosity, and confidence. Data analysis was conducted using SPSS software, applying descriptive statistics, correlation analysis, and regression techniques to test the hypotheses. Findings from the analysis confirmed a significant positive correlation between TQM and career adaptability. Furthermore, regression results demonstrated that TQM practices exert a significant positive effect on employees' career adaptability. These results highlight the importance of embedding quality management principles not only for achieving operational efficiency but also for fostering an agile and adaptable workforce. The study recommends that organizations adopt and institutionalize TQM practices as a strategic approach to enhance both organizational outcomes and employee development.

Keywords: Total Quality Management (TQM), Career Adaptability, IceStar Factory, Sulaimanyah Kurdistan Region of Iraq

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Chapter one

1. Introduction

Organizations modernize their business posture with explorative leadership approaches to stay competitive and build improved work productivity and staff development. One such approach is general great management (Total Quality management (TQM)), a systematic framework aimed at improving techniques, efficiency, and general organizational overall performance thru non-stop improvement, management involvement, and worker engagement (Al-Dhaafri & Alosani, 2020). meanwhile, profession adaptability has become a critical factor in an employee's capacity to navigate profession transitions, technological improvements, and shifting job needs. folks who can smoothly navigate to adjustments of their painting's environment are more likely to experience career increase, activity pleasure, and lengthy-term employability (Stoltz, 2014). (TQM) and career adaptability as separate variables, there's a considerable gap within the literature concerning their direct relationship. most previous studies have focused on how total quality control (TQM) affects organizational overall performance, customer delight, and provider high-quality (Harimurti & Suryani, 2019), at the same time as studies on career adaptability has ordinarily examined elements including employability attributes, task satisfaction, and social capital (Liu & Jew, 2023). But little attention has been given to the ability connection between general fine control (TQM) practices and personnel' ability to conform to profession-associated challenges. this research, we aim to address this hole via investigating the effect of general quality control (TQM) on profession adaptability among employees on the IceStar Ice Cream manufacturing unit in Sulaymaniyah, Kurdistan area. The studies will determine the volume to which total first-class management (TQM) ideas along with non-stop improvement, worker involvement, and management dedication have an effect on personnel' capability to adapt to place of job demanding situations and profession modifications (Arab & Kulualp, 2024). through using a quantitative studies technique, survey information might be accumulated from manufacturing unit personnel and analyzed using SPSS to decide the correlation and potential causality among general first-rate control (TQM) practices and career adaptability (Ali & Anwar, 2021).

1.1 Problem statement

According to our primary investigation in IceStar Ice cream factory we have found out most of the employees have a low level of career adaptability. It may be due to the company not fully applying the philosophy of administration that is up to date like Total quality management.

1.2 Objective

The objective of the current study is to

1. Identify the level of total quality management in the IceStar factory
2. Identify the level of career adaptability in IceStar factory
3. Determine the correlation between Total quality management and career adaptability
4. Determine the effect of Total quality management on career adaptability

1.3 Aim of study

1. Identify the extent of TQM implementation inside the IceStar Ice Cream manufacturing unit.
2. Verify the extent of profession adaptability amongst personnel inside the identical.
3. Decide the correlation among TQM practices and career adaptability.
4. Study the effect of TQM on worker career adaptability.

1.4 Model of the study

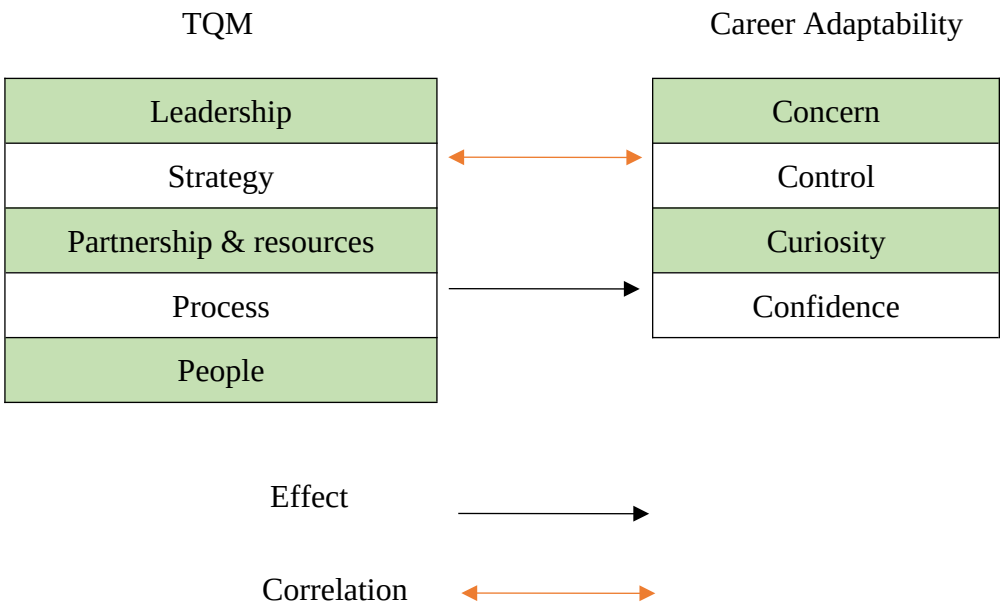

Figure 1: Model of the Study

1.5 Hypotheses

H1: There is a significant Positive correlation between Total Quality Management and career adaptability

H1 a: There is a significant Positive correlation between Leadership and career adaptability

H1 b: There is a significant Positive correlation between Strategy and career adaptability

H1 c: There is a significant Positive correlation between Partnership & Resource and career adaptability

H1 d: There is a significant Positive correlation between Process and career adaptability

H1 e: There is a significant Positive correlation between People and Career Adaptability

H2: Total quality management have a significant positive effect on career adaptability

H2 a: leadership have a significant positive effect on career adaptability

H2 b: Strategy have a significant positive effect on career adaptability

H2 c: Partnership & Resource have a significant positive effect on career adaptability

H2 d: Process have a significant positive effect on career adaptability

H2 e: People have a significant positive effect on career adaptability

Chapter Two

2. Literature Review

2.1 Total Quality Management (TQM)

Total pleasant control is a complete method that makes a specialty of continuous improvement, customer pleasure, and operational excellence. Originating from production industries, total quality management (TQM) has now been widely adopted across various sectors, which includes healthcare, education, and service industries. it's built on the precept that fine isn't always simply an end intention but an ongoing procedure that requires the participation of all personnel at each stage of an organization.

emphasizes a subculture where each worker is liable for best enhancement. It integrates diverse methodologies along with Six Sigma, Lean management, and the Plan-Do-take a look at-Act (p.c.) cycle to streamline methods and decrease inefficiencies. one of the middle objectives of general is to decrease defects, get rid of waste, and create services and products that meet or exceed consumer expectations. groups that effectively put into effecnow not only enhance their operational performance but additionally benefit a competitive facet in their respective industries.

fail to achieve their full capacity. Leaders need to create a imaginative and prescient for fine, establish clear goals, and inspire personnel to take part actively in best development efforts. employee involvement is every other essential component in general organizations that empower their workforce thru education programs, open communication, and recognition for quality contributions tend to experience higher engagement and productiveness.

also heavily is based on information-driven decision-making. Statistical method control, benchmarking, and key overall performance signs (KPIs) help agencies measure the effectiveness in their fine initiatives. by analyzing information and identifying developments, companies can make informed choices that drive continuous development.

Further to its operational blessings, fosters a subculture of innovation and flexibility. companies that combine total excellent control (TQM) concepts are extra resilient to marketplace changes and can rapidly adapt to evolving patron demands. by way of focusing on satisfactory at every degree of the company, no longer handiest complements consumer pleasure but additionally boosts employee morale and ordinary organizational overall performance.

typical, isn't always just a hard and fast of great manipulate techniques but a philosophy that embeds high-quality attention into the company DNA. can count on lengthy-term advantages which includes stepped forward performance, better customer retention, decreased expenses, and a sustainable competitive benefit inside the worldwide marketplace.

2.1.1 Leadership in Total Quality Management (TQM)

management in overall is one of the most vital factors influencing the achievement of great control implementation in an employer. Leaders set the route, set up the imaginative and prescient, and create an environment wherein first-class development will become a fundamental objective. powerful management in requires a commitment to continuous development, a focus on patron pleasure, and the capacity to foster a tradition of excellence. Leaders are liable for defining the great project, growing strategic objectives, and ensuring that personnel align with first-class ideas. strong leadership in extends beyond coverage-making; it calls for active engagement with employees to instill a tradition of duty, innovation, and excellence.

Management in encompasses transformational leadership characteristics in which leaders inspire employees, inspire innovation, and sell a shared vision of high-quality excellence. Transformational leaders serve as role fashions, demonstrating ethical selection-making, powerful communique, and dedication to organizational dreams. They cultivate an inclusive work environment wherein personnel sense valued and inspired to make contributions to first-class improvement efforts. Leaders must act as catalysts for exchange, equipping their teams with the essential know-how and equipment to put in force concepts effectively. through facilitating continuous learning, putting overall performance benchmarks, and worthwhile excellence, leaders create a lifestyle in which best is a collective duty.

A robust leadership approach guarantees the combination of nice management at all levels of the organization. Leaders who fail to emphasize first-class regularly face demanding situations along with low worker engagement, inconsistent tactics, and reduced client delight. research have proven that organizations with effective management record accelerated operational performance, better patron retention fees, and extra employee dedication. furthermore, powerful leadership in calls for a ahead-thinking approach, leveraging technology and statistics-driven decision-making to enhance pleasant requirements. The ability to anticipate market modifications, force innovation, and align organizational objectives with patron desires distinguishes a hit leaders from folks that struggle to acquire sustainable improvements. by prioritizing management development and reinforcing a dedication to excellence, organizations can successfully combine principles into their lengthy-time period strategic framework.

transformational management characteristics where leaders inspire personnel, encourage innovation, and sell a shared imaginative and prescient of first-class excellence. Leaders should act as role models, putting excessive requirements for paintings ethics, collaboration, and continuous studying. additionally, leaders want to facilitate education programs, provide essential sources, and empower employees to take initiative in excellent development initiatives.

A management method guarantees the mixing of pleasant control in any respect levels of the enterprise. Leaders who fail to emphasize fine regularly face demanding situations which includes low employee engagement, inconsistent processes, and reduced customer pride. research have shown that organizations with management record accelerated operational performance, higher purchaser retention quotes, and greater worker dedication (Oakland, 2014).

2.1.2 Strategy in Total Quality Management (TQM)

strategies play a pivotal position in making sure that companies reap lengthy-time period excellence. A properly-defined approach outlines the stairs an employer takes to embed first-class principles into its middle operations. corporations have to develop techniques that target continuous development, error discount, and sustainable commercial enterprise increase. those

techniques help align corporate desires with nice enhancement efforts and create a established method to preserving

A method requires a sturdy dedication from leadership, well-defined guidelines, and a way of life that values non-stop gaining knowledge of and employee participation. businesses that integrate overall strategies into their long-time period enterprise plans are more likely to maintain competitive benefits in their industries. This integration no longer best improves operational performance however also enhances purchaser pleasure, as a

total quality control (strategies additionally emphasize proactive problem-solving strategies in place of reactive ones. groups that concentrate on figuring out potential best problems earlier than they arise can put into effect preventive measures to minimize defects and inefficiencies. This forward-thinking method allows corporations to optimize their sources, streamline production processes, and reduce waste, leading to cost financial savings and ordinary improved overall performance. additionally, a well-established overall excellent management method carries worker schooling and engagement, making sure that every one group individuals are aligned with the company's high-quality goals and are empowered to contribute to continuous improvement efforts.

One of the key elements of a successful general great strategy is information-pushed selection-making. corporations that analyze records to identify method inefficiencies and patron issues can put in force focused enhancements that lead to higher pleasant standards. the usage of overall performance metrics, key overall performance indicators (KPIs), and benchmarking enables corporations to song development and make informed decisions concerning quality projects.

Strategic making plans in general best management additionally entails the improvement of a pleasant-centric way of life. companies should train employees on the importance of nice, make sure leadership dedication, and establish reward structures that recognize fine achievements. A robust overall best control method is likewise patron-oriented, as it prioritizes purchaser pride via stepped forward product and carrier delivery (Robinson, 2019).

2.1.3 Partnership and Resources in Total Quality Management (TQM)

Building robust partnerships and efficaciously handling resources is important for a implementation. companies must collaborate with suppliers, stakeholders, and clients to expand quality-enhancing techniques. provider partnerships play a essential position in making sure that uncooked substances, components, and services meet the favored fine standards. A properly-established supplier exceptional control gadget guarantees consistency and reduces the risk state-of-the-art defects in the final product. establishing strong relationships with suppliers enables create a continuing supply chain that complements the overall performance and reliability cutting-edge operations. corporations that prioritize supplier great management frequently see reductions in production charges, fewer defects, and improved consumer satisfaction. moreover, strategic supplier partnerships allow agencies to leverage shared knowledge, undertake new technologies, and reply to market demands with greater agility.

Further to dealer collaboration, attractive with stakeholders is every other key resource control. effective stakeholder engagement guarantees that each one parties concerned inside the enterprise system, from investors and regulatory organizations to personnel and clients, align with the organization's nice goals. Stakeholders offer valuable insights that can manually groups in refining their exceptional strategies and adapting to industry shifts. agencies that actively involve stakeholders in selection-making tactics create a transparent and cooperative work environment, which fosters trust and promotes shared obligation for exceptional enhancements.

organizations should put money into high-quality schooling, technological advancements, and method optimization to sustain first-rate improvements. powerful aid control ensures that personnel have get admission to to the necessary equipment, gadget, and understanding required to uphold exceptional requirements. agencies that fail to allocate enough resources for first-class projects cutting-edge experience manufacturing inefficiencies and expanded operational charges. making an investment in technology, efforts by way of improving accuracy, decreasing human errors, and optimizing workflow efficiencies.

Workforce development is a similarly essential aid control. corporations ought to provide personnel with ongoing education applications, career development opportunities, and access to nice management equipment to preserve excessive levels cutting-edge performance. A well-trained body of workers now not most effective enhances the nice modern-day services and products but additionally contributes to a lifestyle brand new continuous improvement. worker involvement in first-class management initiatives fosters engagement, creativity, and hassle-solving skills,

Economic assets ought to additionally be strategically allotted to aid best control initiatives. Budgeting for excellent control, overall performance checks, and compliance with enterprise requirements guarantees that organizations stay aggressive and able to meeting patron expectations. agencies that fail to put money into pleasant tasks trendy face better costs in the end state-of-the-art defects, recollects, and patron dissatisfaction. A nicely-planned financial approach that prioritizes excellent investments can result in lengthy-term premodernity and sustainability.

Environmental sustainability is some other rising component useful resource control. Many organizations at the moment are integrating sustainability projects into their excellent management frameworks to limit waste, lessen electricity consumption, and adopt manufacturing strategies. Sustainable useful resource control no longer best blessings the surroundings but additionally enhances logo reputation and client loyalty. organizations that proactively put into effect green projects and environmentally pleasant deliver chain practices align with global developments and regulatory requirements, making sure lengthy-time period commercial enterprise viability.

Normal, effective partnership-building and resource control are. corporations that prioritize dealer collaboration, stakeholder engagement, group of workers development, technological investment, and sustainability can create a robust foundation for pleasant excellence. via strategically coping with sources and fostering lengthy-term partnerships, groups can beautify operational efficiency, improve product and service high-quality, and acquire a sustainable competitive gain within the marketplace.

Aid allocation is some other critical thing state-of-the-art organizations need to invest in pleasant education, technological improvements, and method optimization to maintain great enhancements.

effective useful resource management guarantees that personnel have get right of entry to the essential equipment, device, and information required to uphold great standards. groups that fail to allocate enough assets for fine projects modern-day revel in production inefficiencies and improved operational costs (Oakland, 2014).

2.1.4 Process in Total Quality Management (TQM)

Procedure control is a cornerstone of general first-rate control, as it ensures that organizations follow standardized processes that cause regular nice results. It serves as the foundation for operational excellence, providing a dependent method to preserving first-rate and performance in production, provider transport, and administrative capabilities. with the aid of implementing effective process control, agencies can make certain that each level of their operations is aligned with the ideas of non-stop development, in the long run enhancing productiveness and decreasing operational inefficiencies(Jonson, 2020).

Process optimization is a fundamental aspect of system control, because it makes a specialty of casting off waste, reducing mistakes, and enhancing performance. A well-optimized manner minimizes redundant activities, streamlines workflows, and guarantees that sources are utilized correctly. groups that actively engage in manner optimization benefit from increased value financial savings, better purchaser pleasure, and a more agile reaction to market needs(Green 2019).

cycle, brought via Deming, is one of the most extensively used methodologies in manner improvement. The p.c. cycle encourages continuous assessment and refinement of methods to acquire most fulfilling performance. This iterative model permits companies to test new thoughts, enforce incremental enhancements, and determine outcomes before making lengthy-time period changes. through following this approach, agencies can systematically discover inefficiencies and expand strategies to cope with them, fostering a tradition of ongoing high-quality(Holiday 2018).

A hit procedure management in overall excellent control additionally includes first-class audits, statistical method control, and 6 Sigma methodologies. these strategies assist pick out defects,

examine root causes, and enforce corrective moves to decorate operational overall performance. fine audits provide a based evaluation of present techniques to make certain compliance with hooked up requirements and regulations. Statistical process manage allows companies to reveal variations in manufacturing and stumble on inconsistencies earlier than they effect final product satisfactory. Six Sigma, a statistics-driven methodology, emphasizes the reduction of defects and variability in methods, main to advanced consistency and reliability(Tiwa L. 2021).

Organizations that adopt based process control techniques document better productiveness stages, reduced production charges, and extended client delight. procedure management not most effective supports operational efficiency however also performs a vital function in danger control through figuring out potential troubles before they amplify into important issues. agencies that invest in procedure standardization and automation can in addition enhance efficiency, permitting employees to awareness on value-adding activities rather than manual blunders correction (Kilain 2024).

In the end, method management is an critical detail of total first-class management , as it ensures that groups keep requirements, adapt to converting market dynamics, and preserve non-stop improvement. groups that prioritize procedure management as part of their general high-quality control (TQM) tasks benefit a competitive benefit by way of turning in superior services and products at the same time as keeping value efficiency and operational excellence.

A success process control in total high-quality management also involves first-rate audits, statistical process control, and six Sigma methodologies. those techniques help identify defects, examine root causes, and put in force corrective movements to decorate operational performance.

2.1.5 People in Total Quality Management (TQM)

Personnel are the riding force at the back of general and their active participation is vital for achieving exceptional excellence. agencies have to awareness on employee engagement,

continuous schooling, and overall performance reputation to foster a way of life of pleasant. overall concepts emphasize teamwork, collaboration, and open conversation to make sure that fine dreams are met efficiently. A well-engaged staff is crucial in executing excellent techniques and sustaining operational upgrades through the years. groups that create surroundings wherein personnel sense valued and empowered are much more likely to sustain long-time period achievement of their satisfactory control efforts(Jaine . A 2018).

Employee engagement in goes past primary participation it entails fostering a culture wherein every employee is familiar with the significance of satisfactory and takes private responsibility for it. groups that encourage worker-driven first-class tasks generally tend to have a extra motivated body of workers, leading to better innovation, efficiency, and service excellence. This engagement is cultivated via schooling programs that equip employees with the essential talents and information to make a contribution successfully to nice management.

organizations that put money into expert development possibilities, together with leadership applications, skill enhancement workshops, and arms-on great control education, enable their workforce to live ahead of enterprise adjustments and adapt to new technological advancements. imparting personnel with based gaining knowledge of opportunities ensures that they continue to be engaged, informed, and capable of enhancing organizational approaches (Albert 2021).

Research indicates that companies with robust worker involvement iexperience lower turnover quotes, progressed paintings morale, and expanded innovation. personnel who feel valued and covered in selection-making processes are much more likely to remain devoted to the employer and actively make a contribution to its fulfillment. recognition and reward programs in addition beautify employee participation, reinforcing the concept that first-rate development is a collective obligation. additionally, fostering a collaborative work surroundings in which employees can

Corporations that prioritize employee involvement in overall additionally benefit from more adaptability to market modifications and patron needs. employees who actively take part in continuous improvement efforts make contributions to process efficiency, consumer delight, and long-term organizational resilience. through fostering that emphasizes accountability, innovation,

and excellence, businesses can make certain that their group of workers stays committed to satisfactory initiatives, main to sustainable growth and operational excellence (Californ 2019)

2.2 Career Adaptability (CA)

Career adaptability is a critical concept in modern-day profession improvement theories, specializing in a man or woman's capacity to successfully manipulate career transitions, workplace demanding situations, and evolving activity requirements. The capacity to conform to career-associated modifications is becoming increasingly important in nowadays speedy-paced and technology-pushed job market. profession adaptability encompasses a set of psychosocial assets that enable personnel to stay proactive, resilient, and open to change. those adaptability assets help people deal with new professional needs, reply to process uncertainties, and take manage in their profession paths (Savickas, 2015).

In a technology of rapid technological improvements, globalization, and converting hard work marketplace needs, profession adaptability has grown to be a key determinant of lengthy-term profession achievement. The upward thrust of automation, artificial intelligence, and digital transformation requires employees to continuously replace their talents and continue to be flexible of their profession alternatives. personnel with excessive profession adaptability show off extra resilience while going through task displacement, industry shifts, and evolving workplace expectations. moreover, profession adaptability is carefully related to employability, as people who proactively broaden their talents and know-how are more likely to secure sustainable employment opportunities.

Career adaptability is also a mental assemble that influences how individuals perceive their capacity to navigate profession-related challenges. studies indicates that employees who possess a high degree of profession adaptability show more confidence, trouble-solving abilities, and job pleasure. businesses that prioritize profession adaptability foster a workforce that is ready for future modifications, thereby reducing worker turnover and increasing universal engagement. businesses that invest in expert development applications, profession counseling, and mentoring

initiatives contribute to building a resilient team of workers that may efficiently manage career transitions and expert boom.

Furthermore, profession adaptability performs a vital function in administrative center performance and productiveness. personnel who are distinctly adaptable are better geared up to handle surprising modifications in their task roles, transferring organizational priorities, and enterprise disruptions. They display more initiative, creativity, and hassle-fixing competencies, which beautify their potential to make contributions meaningfully to organizational fulfillment. studies have proven that career adaptability is strongly correlated with profession pleasure, job retention, and leadership development (Hirschi, 2020). businesses that guide profession adaptability create a surroundings where personnel sense empowered to take rate in their career paths and continuously try for expert excellence.

Some other essential thing of profession adaptability is its dating with mental fitness and nicely-being. career uncertainty and job insecurity are common sources of stress in today's group of workers, and people with low career adaptability regularly struggle with anxiety and career dissatisfaction. high adaptability, however, facilitates employees develop coping mechanisms, resilience, and a boom-orientated attitude, which undoubtedly effect their mental nicely-being. businesses that apprehend the significance of profession adaptability ought to implement mental health aid programs, career coaching periods, and mentorship possibilities to make sure that employees are well-prepared for profession-related demanding situations.

Career adaptability is likewise inspired by way of external and inner elements. external elements include enterprise traits, hard work marketplace situations, financial shifts, and technological improvements, even as inner elements are associated with private motivation, career aspirations, self-efficacy, and ability development. personnel who actively are looking for career boom opportunities, have interaction in lifelong studying, and stay open to new reports are more likely to develop sturdy profession adaptability skills.

In precis, profession adaptability is a multidimensional construct that encompasses a number of private and expert attributes vital for career success. It plays a massive function in career making

plans, task performance, mental well-being, and long-time period employability. organizations that combine profession adaptability techniques into their talent control frameworks will create a extra resilient, engaged, and destiny-prepared staff. profession adaptability includes a couple of dimensions, along with challenge, manipulate, curiosity, and self-belief, all of which make contributions to a person's capacity to efficaciously handle career-associated decisions and demanding situations.

Profession adaptability is a critical idea in cutting-edge profession development theories, that specialize in an individual's ability to correctly control profession transitions, place of work challenges, and evolving task requirements. The capacity to adapt to profession-related changes is turning into increasingly more vital in today's rapid-paced and era-pushed task marketplace. career adaptability encompasses a hard and fast of psychosocial resources that allow employees to remain proactive, resilient, and open to trade. those adaptability resources help people cope with new professional needs, respond to activity uncertainties, and take manage of their profession paths (Savickas, 2020).

In a technology of fast technological advancements, globalization, and converting labor market needs, career adaptability has grown to be a key determinant of long-term profession fulfillment. The upward thrust of automation, artificial intelligence, and virtual transformation calls for personnel to constantly update their skills and remain flexible of their profession selections. employees with excessive profession adaptability showcase greater resilience when going through process displacement, industry shifts, and evolving place of business expectancies. furthermore, profession adaptability is carefully connected to employability, as individuals who proactively expand their abilities and know-how are much more likely to at ease sustainable employment possibilities.

Career adaptability is also a psychological construct that influences how people understand their ability to navigate career-related demanding situations. studies indicates that employees who own an excessive diploma of career adaptability demonstrate more self-assurance, problem-solving abilities, and process delight. agencies that prioritize profession adaptability foster personnel that is

ready for destiny adjustments, thereby decreasing employee turnover and increasing standard engagement. companies that put money into expert development programs, profession counseling, and mentoring projects make a contribution to constructing a resilient body of workers that can effectively manipulate career transitions and professional increase.

Career adaptability plays a critical function in long-term profession delight and success. employees with high adaptability levels are more likely to experience expert boom, job pleasure, and career durability. research has shown that career adaptability drastically enhances employability, permitting individuals to navigate shifts in enterprise traits, organizational restructuring, and financial fluctuations. It includes more than one dimensions, consisting of issue, manage, interest, and self-assurance, all of which make a contribution to a character's potential to successfully manage career-associated selections and demanding situations.

Profession adaptability is a critical idea in contemporary profession development theories, that specialize in character's capacity to efficiently manage profession transitions, administrative center challenges, and evolving activity requirements. The potential to evolve to profession-associated changes is turning into more and more essential in nowadays rapid-paced and era-driven activity marketplace. career adaptability encompasses a set of psychosocial sources that allow employees to remain proactive, resilient, and open to exchange. these adaptability assets assist people deal with new expert demands, respond to task uncertainties, and take manage in their career paths (Savickas, 2020).

Career adaptability plays a vital function in long-time period profession delight and success. personnel with excessive adaptability levels are much more likely to experience professional boom, job pleasure, and profession sturdiness. research has proven that career adaptability substantially enhances employability, permitting individuals to navigate shifts in enterprise tendencies, organizational restructuring, and economic fluctuations. It includes more than one dimensions, consisting of issue, manage, interest, and self-assurance, all of which make a contribution to a man or woman's capability to successfully handle career-associated decisions and demanding situations (Plack 2019).

2.2.1 Concern in Career Adaptability

Career manipulate refers to a man or woman's capacity to take ownership of their career alternatives, giving them the autonomy to shape their expert adventure primarily based mostly on aspirations, corporation demands, and evolving talent requirements. personnel with strong career manage are proactive in looking for new roles, developing capabilities, and handling career transitions. This self-directed approach to career development lets in human beings to make informed alternatives approximately their expert paths, ensuring that they align with non-public desires and agency inclinations. profession control fosters a deep feel of empowerment, encouraging employees to take initiative in career planning, potential acquisition, and networking. personnel who actively workout career manipulate are much more likely to engage in non-prevent analyzing, embody career increase possibilities, and adapt to organizational modifications with self-assurance (J.R. Hamsh).

The idea of career control is rooted in self-efficacy, which refers to an person's notion in their capability to influence profession effects. personnel with excessive career control understand disturbing situations as opportunities instead of obstacles, letting them navigate technique uncertainties with resilience. they may be more willing to are trying to find mentorship, gather new certifications, and take on leadership roles interior their groups. additionally, profession manipulate performs a vital function in professional identity formation, as folks who revel in in price of their careers are more likely to pursue paintings that aligns with their values and interests.

Corporations that foster a culture of career control provide personnel with autonomy, selection-making authority, and opportunities for career development. companies that help career control frequently see higher employee engagement, as people experience valued and induced to make a contribution to the company's success. career manage is likewise linked to interest pride and career achievement, as personnel who have company over their career trajectories generally have a tendency to revel in more expert properly-being. by way of manner of implementing career development applications, mentorship duties, and management training, agencies can create an

environment that empowers employees to take charge of their careers, ultimately primary to a extra inspired and resilient group of workers.

Furthermore, career manage right now influences place of work standard overall performance, innovation, and common assignment willpower. employees who're given the liberty to make career-related selections show off higher tiers of creativity, hassle-solving skills, and adaptableness to transferring process roles. They take duty for their professional increase, making sure that they remain applicable in an ever-converting hard work market. groups that inspire profession manage advantage from a group of workers that isn't always most effective devoted however also quite agile, geared up to tackle new obligations and annoying conditions with self-perception.

Further, career manage contributes to financial stability and long-term career achievement. personnel who actively plan and control their careers are much more likely to are looking for promotions, negotiate better salaries, and discover high-boom industries. A body of employees that physical games profession manipulate is one that continuously strives for excellence, main to progressed agency typical overall performance and employee retention. agencies that understand the significance of career control as part of their human resource approach will now not best maintain top skills however additionally create a thriving administrative center way of life built on ambition, resilience, and long-time period profession satisfaction (Solin 2019).

Businesses that foster a subculture of profession control provide employees with autonomy, choice-making authority, and opportunities for career improvement. businesses that help profession control often see better employee engagement, as personnel feel valued and inspired to contribute to the business enterprise's success. profession manipulate is likewise linked to hobby delight and career success, as personnel who have business enterprise over their profession trajectories have a propensity to experience more professional well-being. with the aid of imposing

2.2.2 Control in Career Adaptability

Career control refers to an individual’s ability to take ownership of their career decisions, giving them the autonomy to shape their professional journey based on aspirations, industry demands, and

evolving skill requirements. Employees with strong career control are proactive in seeking new roles, developing competencies, and managing career transitions. This self-directed approach to career development allows individuals to make informed decisions about their professional paths, ensuring that they align with personal goals and industry trends. Career control fosters a deep sense of empowerment, encouraging employees to take initiative in career planning, skill acquisition, and networking. Employees who actively exercise career control are more likely to engage in continuous learning, embrace career growth opportunities, and adapt to organizational changes with confidence (Marla 2018).

The concept of career control is rooted in self-efficacy, which refers to an individual's belief in their ability to influence career outcomes. Employees with high career control perceive challenges as opportunities rather than obstacles, allowing them to navigate job uncertainties with resilience. They are more inclined to seek mentorship, acquire new certifications, and take on leadership roles within their organizations. Additionally, career control plays a vital role in professional identity formation, as individuals who feel in charge of their careers are more likely to pursue work that aligns with their values and interests.

Organizations that foster a culture of career control provide employees with autonomy, decision-making authority, and opportunities for career advancement. Companies that support career control often see higher employee engagement, as workers feel valued and motivated to contribute to the organization's success. Career control is also linked to job satisfaction and career fulfillment, as employees who have agency over their career trajectories tend to experience greater professional well-being. By implementing career development programs, mentorship initiatives, and leadership training, organizations can create an environment that empowers employees to take charge of their careers, ultimately leading to a more motivated and resilient workforce.

Furthermore, career control directly influences workplace performance, innovation, and overall job commitment. Employees who are given the freedom to make career-related decisions demonstrate higher levels of creativity, problem-solving abilities, and adaptability to shifting job roles. They take responsibility for their professional growth, ensuring that they remain relevant in

an ever-changing labor market. Companies that encourage career control benefit from a workforce that is not only committed but also highly agile, ready to take on new projects and challenges with confidence (Brigiston 2018).

In addition, career control contributes to financial stability and long-term career success. Employees who actively plan and manage their careers are more likely to seek promotions, negotiate better salaries, and explore high-growth industries. A workforce that exercises career control is one that continuously strives for excellence, leading to improved company performance and employee retention. Organizations that recognize the importance of career control as part of their human resource strategy will not only retain top talent but also create a thriving workplace culture built on ambition, resilience, and long-term career satisfaction.

Organizations that foster a culture of career control provide employees with autonomy, decision-making authority, and opportunities for career advancement. Companies that support career control often see higher employee engagement, as workers feel valued and motivated to contribute to the organization's success. Career control is also linked to job satisfaction and career fulfillment, as employees.

2.2.3 Curiosity in Career Adaptability

Career interest encourages employees to explore diverse career paths, acquire new information, and include non-stop learning. employees who display interest actively are seeking out facts, community with industry professionals, and remain open to new profession possibilities. This inquisitive attitude allows people to discover emerging career possibilities, adapt to industry developments, and enhance their professional skills. profession curiosity also performs a essential role in fostering innovation, as personnel who are inclined to study and discover new opportunities

Agencies can support profession interest through mentorship applications, job rotation schemes, and information-sharing systems. by way of presenting employees get right of entry to to cross-departmental experiences, professional networking opportunities, and education applications, companies can domesticate a lifestyle of continuous gaining knowledge of. Encouraging curiosity

in the group of workers allows employees remain agile and responsive to the evolving needs of the activity marketplace. moreover, profession interest enhances resilience, as employees with a sturdy experience of interest are much more likely to view career boundaries as gaining knowledge of possibilities instead of setbacks.

Groups that prioritize career curiosity of their body of workers development strategies also advantage from increased worker engagement and delight. personnel who have the freedom to explore numerous profession alternatives within a company are more likely to remain devoted to their roles and make a contribution meaningfully to enterprise goals. through fostering an environment that nurtures interest, businesses can release untapped capability of their personnel, using long-term success and sustainability.

2.2.4 Confidence in Career Adaptability

Career self-belief is the belief in a single's ability to efficiently navigate career challenges and achieve expert goals. It plays a fundamental position in shaping career trajectories, influencing choice-making, and improving expert resilience. employees with high career self-assurance are more adaptable, proactive, and self-confident in overcoming workplace boundaries, which contributes to their long-time period fulfillment, job stability, and career delight. self-belief is cultivated through revel in, mentorship, talent development, and high-quality reinforcement, all of which play a vital position in shaping an individual's capacity to deal with career transitions, professional setbacks, and process-associated challenges efficiently.

Profession confidence permits individuals to take calculated risks, are seeking for profession advancement possibilities, and interact in non-stop learning without worry of failure. personnel who own robust career self-belief tend to show leadership qualities, initiative, and hassle-fixing skills, making them treasured property to their agencies. An assured group of workers is much more likely to embody change, adapt to new technologies, and make contributions to organizational innovation. employees with career self-belief are more willing to project themselves, step into management roles, and advocate for their very own professional increase.

A first-rate issue influencing profession self-assurance is self-efficacy, or the notion in a single's own talents to reach unique conditions. personnel with strong self-efficacy are much more likely to persevere in difficult paintings environments, are looking for out expert improvement possibilities, and continue to be dedicated to lengthy-time period profession dreams. career confidence is likewise strongly associated with activity overall performance, as employees who sense capable of dealing with administrative center demanding situations have a tendency to be more engaged, effective, and motivated to excel.

Corporations can enhance profession confidence through supplying management training, overall performance comments, structured career improvement packages, and mentorship opportunities. presenting employees with access to continuous studying projects, professional networking occasions, and know-how-sharing structures fosters surroundings in which they are able to develop and give a boost to their self-belief through the years. additionally, corporations that put into effect reputation and reward systems fortify nice place of job behaviors, ensuring that personnel feel valued, supported, and encouraged to increase of their careers.

Career self-assurance additionally has a profound effect on worker retention and task pleasure. people who trust of their competencies are more likely to stay devoted to their corporations, searching for inner increase opportunities, and make a contribution meaningfully to employer targets. employees with high career self-belief have a tendency to be greater bold, purpose-orientated, and resilient inside the face of career setbacks. organizations that prioritize constructing career confidence amongst their group of workers benefit from a especially inspired, engaged, and high-acting skills pool, in the long run leading to advanced organizational success.

Moreover, career confidence is a key determinant of economic stability and profession development. employees who're assured in their abelites are more likely to barter better salaries, pursue promotions, and secure management positions within their fields. Self-belief also enables individuals to make strategic profession choices, whether or not it be transitioning into new roles, starting entrepreneurial ventures, or expanding their professional skillsets to conform to evolving enterprise needs.

2.3 The Role of Total Quality Management in Organizational Success

General first-class control (TQM) is a established technique aimed at enhancing an enterprise's techniques, performance, and customer delight via continuous development, worker involvement, and robust management. organizations that enforce TQM practices advantage from more suitable operational overall performance, decreased defects, and better worker engagement. through fostering a tradition of quality and non-stop studying, agencies make sure that personnel are nicely-trained and motivated to contribute to enterprise excellence. TQM isn't handiest about enhancing services and products however also approximately refining managerial strategies and operational workflows, leading to a extra adaptive and resilient team of workers. powerful implementation of TQM creates a sustainable competitive gain, as companies can reply proactively to market demands, technological changes, and patron desires.

2.4 Career Adaptability and Its Importance in Employee Development

Profession adaptability is a critical competency that permits employees to manipulate career transitions, place of work challenges, and expert growth opportunities efficaciously. It includes key dimensions including subject, control, curiosity, and self-assurance, all of which make a contribution to an individual’s potential to navigate career-associated uncertainties. personnel with high career adaptability are higher prepared to deal with job modifications, enterprise adjustments, and new talent necessities, main to extra activity pride and long-term employability. agencies that assist profession adaptability through training programs, mentorship, and profession making plans assets can cultivate a more engaged and resilient body of workers. by using aligning profession improvement tasks with commercial enterprise objectives, agencies can make sure that their personnel remain productive, progressive, and prepared for destiny career improvements.

Table 1: Previous Studies about Total Quality Management

Research 1	
Name of Researcher (Year)	Yaşar Akça, Gökhan Özer, esat Kalaycıoğlu (2018)
Title	Total quality Management on Employee Performance
Type of Study	Survey questions, hypotheses, analyses
Place of Study	Turkey
Sample Size	450
Statistical Package	SPSS
Aim	to measure the employee performance among bank and insurance companies
Result	according to analysis results that evaluated career adaptability on work performance, four dimensions of career adaptability (anxiety, control, curiosity and trust) have positive effect on workers‟ work performance.
Recommendation	studies and researches can be carried out with different business fields and sampling groups and impact of the concept on different organizational behavior fields can be analyzed. Factors that may contribute to developing individual career adaptability can be another significant research topic.
Research 2	
Name of Researcher (Year)	Elleen Stoltz 2014
Title	EMPLOYABILITY ATTRIBUTES AND CAREER ADAPTABILITY AS PREDICTORS OF STAFF SATISFACTION WITH RETENTION FACTORS Total quality Management
Type of Study	A cross-sectional quantitative, correlational research
Place of Study	South African
Sample Size	321
Statistical Package	SPSS
Aim	to determine the relationship between employability attributes (measured by the Employability Attributes Scale), career adaptability (measured by the Career-Adapt Abilities Scale) and retention factors (measured by the Retention Factor Scale)
Result	it is trusted that the findings of the study provided insights into the relationship between individuals' employability attributes, career adaptability and satisfaction with retention factors
Recommendation	Different models should be used to investigate the relationship between

	employability attributes, career adaptability and retention factors.
Research 3	
Name of Researcher (Year)	Santos, G., Sá, J. C., Félix, M. J., Barreto, L., Carvalho, F., Doiro, M., Zgodavová, K., & Stefanović, M. (2021)
Title	New Needed Quality Management Skills for Quality Managers Total quality Management
Type of Study	Empirical study (survey-based research).
Place of Study	Portugal
Sample Size	90
Statistical Package	SPSS
Aim	To analyze if quality management employees perceive the impact of Industry 4.0 on their profession and the required skills. To review and analyze the main topics related to quality management in the context of the fourth industrial revolution (Industry 4.0).
Result	Quality management professionals must possess skills such as creative thinking, leadership, teamwork, communication, and knowledge of ICT and Industry 4.0 pillars. They must also be able to motivate teams, manage conflicts, use Big Data for decision-making, and be open to change.
Recommendation	Quality management professionals should adapt to the demands of Industry 4.0 by developing the identified skills and competencies.
Research 4	
Name of Researcher (Year)	Rosa Harimurti 2019
Title	The Impact of Total Quality Management on Service Quality, Customer Engagement, And Customer Loyalty In Banking
Type of Study	Empirical study (quantitative research using Partial Least Square SEM analysis).
Place of Study	East Java Province, Indonesia.
Sample Size	209
Statistical Package	Partial Least Square Structural Equation Modeling (PLS-SEM).
Aim	To examine the effect of Total Quality Management (TQM) implementation on Service Quality.
Result	TQM practices have a positive effect on Service Quality.
Recommendation	State-Owned Enterprises (SOE) banks should implement TQM effectively to enhance Service Quality, which in turn improves Customer Engagement and Customer Loyalty.

Research 5	
Name of Researcher (Year)	Bayad Jamal Ali & Govand Anwar (2021)
Title	Work Engagement: How Does Employee Work Engagement Influence Employee Satisfaction for Total quality Management
Type of Study	Quantitative Research
Place of Study	Private companies in Erbil, Kurdistan Region, Iraq
Sample Size	108
Statistical Package	spss
Aim	To investigate the link between work engagement (including various factors like equal opportunities, personal influence, career nature, development opportunities, employee recognition, work challenge, supervisor behavior, ethics and integrity, and job empowerment) and job satisfaction in private companies in Erbil
Result	The study found that workplace challenge was the most significant factor influencing work engagement, with a value of 0.671 and a P-value of 0.000. Employees were engaged due to time management, overburdening tasks, and communication.
Recommendation	The study emphasized the importance of workplace challenges in motivating employees to engage more with their organizations. It suggests that further research with a larger sample size is needed, as the limited number of participants in the current study restricts the generalizability of the findings.
Research 6	
Name of the researchers / year	(Karatepe & Olugbade, 2016)
Title	The effects of work social support and career adaptability on career satisfaction and turnover intentions with Total quality Management
Type of the study	Quantitative
Place of the study	Abuja, Nigeria
Sample size	287
Statistical package	SPSS
Aim of the study	this study develops and tests a research model that investigates whether career adaptability mediates the effect of work social support on career satisfaction and turnover intentions
Result	Hypothesis 1 and 2 are accepted. The results indicate that work social support significantly and positively affects career satisfaction, while it has a significant negative effect on turnover intentions. The results

	suggest that coworker and supervisor support as the indicators of work social support jointly boost career adaptability.
Recommendation	First, management should focus on promoting career adaptability, because this gives the necessary tools to employees to handle their career development effectively. Second, it should be noted that employees need job resources to be able to handle difficulties and challenges in their career development because work social support enhances career adaptability. Second, it should be noted that employees need job resources to be able to handle difficulties and challenges in their career development because work social support enhances career adaptability.
Research 7	
Name of the researchers/ year	Irfan Hameed, Sanam Brohi, Atif Shahab /2020
Title	Impact of Proactive Personality on Total quality Management and Their Intentions for Expatriate
Type of the study	Quantitative
Place of the study	Pakistan
Sample size	297
Statistical package	Excel
Aim of the study	This study examines the mediating effect of resilience between proactive personality and career adaptability, and the mediating effect of cultural intelligence between intentions on expatriate career and career adaptability
Result	proactive personality has a significantly positive impact on career adaptability. resilience mediates the positive and significant relationship between proactive personality and career adaptability.
Recommendation	First, future studies should investigate the implication to pursuing a career as an expatriate rather than intentions, by evaluating the relationship that proactive personality influences adapting career as an expatriate.

Research 8	
Name of the researchers /year	Idda Felice S. Francisco and Mary Caroline N. Castano / 2020
Title	The Impact of Career Adaptability to the Job Search Strategies of Graduate Students in NCR
Type of the study	Quantitative
Place of the study	Manila, Philippines
Sample size	388
Statistical package	Excel
Aim of the study	This study aims to examine the influence of career adaptability on job search strategies that graduate students employ during the process of job searching. This study also aims to
Results	The positive path coefficients indicate that the higher level of career concern and career curiosity would lead to a greater focused strategy and that a higher level of career curiosity and career confidence would also lead to higher level of exploratory strategy. The focused strategy proved to have a significant positive effect on the number of jobs offered. This indicates that the higher the use of focused strategy, the higher the number of jobs offered.
Recommendation	Labor and employment organizations can conduct training programs and seminars for job seekers about career adaptability. Higher education institutions can add career courses that intend to improve individuals' career adaptability which will benefit the career development of the graduate students in the long run.

Table 2: Previous Studies about Career Adaptability

Research 1

Name of Researcher (Year)	Omar Abdulsattar Kamel Sandel ARAB & Halime GÖKTAŞ KULUALP 2024
Title	Relationships Between Total Quality Management Components and Career Adaptability in Higher Education Institutions
Type of Study	Quantitative Study (Survey-Based Research)
Place of Study	Samarra University, Iraq
Sample Size	400 employees surveyed at Samarra University
Statistical Package	Descriptive analysis, reliability and validity analyses, factor analysis, correlation analysis, and regression analysis
Aim	To investigate the impact of Total Quality Management (TQM) on employee performance in higher education institutions, focusing on the influence of TQM components such as leadership, continuous improvement, and employee involvement.
Result	TQM practices, including leadership, continuous improvement, and employee involvement, have a positive and significant impact on employee performance in higher education institutions.
Recommendation	Higher education institutions should prioritize the implementation of TQM components, particularly leadership, continuous improvement, and employee involvement, to enhance employee performance.
Research 2	
Name of Researcher (Year)	Aud Alsaqer, Ihab Katar, Abdelhakim Abdelhadi 2024
Title	The Role of Career Adaptability in Enhancing Customer Satisfaction in Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) Countries
Type of Study	Quantitative Study (Secondary Data Analysis)
Place of Study	Telecommunications sector in Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) countries
Sample Size	354
Statistical Package	STATA Software
Aim	To examine the role of Total Quality Management (TQM) practices, specifically continuous improvement, customer focus, process management, and employee engagement, in enhancing sustainability and customer satisfaction in the telecommunications sector.
Result	Employee engagement and process management had a positive and statistically significant effect on customer satisfaction.
Recommendation	Integrating TQM practices, particularly employee engagement and process management, to enhance customer satisfaction in the telecommunications sector.
Research 3	
Name of	Saif Al Hajri (2020)

Researcher (Year)	
Title	The Impact of Career Adaptability Combined with the Systems Thinking Concept on the Organizational Performance of the UAE's Oil and Gas Firms
Type of Study	Mixed-Methods Study (Quantitative and Qualitative)
Place of Study	Oil and Gas Firms in Abu Dhabi, UAE
Sample Size	88 survey respondents (oil and gas leaders and employees) 9 face to face interview
Statistical Package	Quantitative analysis of survey data (statistical significance found) Thematic analysis for qualitative data
Aim	To determine how the core values of Total Quality Management (TQM) influence the attainment of organizational goals in oil and gas firms in Abu Dhabi. The study also examines organizational processes through the perceptions and experiences of the participants.
Result	Statistically significant results were found between all three independent variables (TQM practices) and organizational performance, with the highest correlation found between organizational climate and performance.
Recommendation	Ensure close collaboration and cooperation across firms, and align all members' goals and objectives.
Research 4	
Name of Researcher (Year)	Abdulrahman Alfaifi (2018)
Title	Developing a Framework for Employee Engagement in Large Organisations in the Arabic Gulf Region by Leveraging National Culture
Type of Study	(Mixed-Methods Study)
Place of Study	Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) region, particularly the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia
Sample Size	
Statistical Package	Not specifically mentioned, but survey data likely analyzed quantitatively, and field experiment conducted
Aim	To develop and validate a framework to improve employee engagement in large organisations in the GCC region, with a particular focus on Saudi Arabia, by considering national culture and other region-specific factors.
Result	Validation studies showed that these revised enablers predicted employee engagement and perceptions of performance, and changes implemented in a treatment group resulted in greater levels of engagement.

Recommendation	The study recommends integrating region-specific cultural factors, such as the role of Islamic practicalities and power distance, into frameworks for employee engagement in the GCC region. It suggests further tailoring engagement strategies to accommodate local cultural norms and leadership styles.
Research 5	
Name of Researcher (Year)	Ghada M. Ibrahim, Imtissal Bachir El Akkaoui, Mohammed Waleed Wahbi 2024
Title	Career Adaptability as a Tool for Marketing Performance Improvement: A Case of Oil and Gas Company in Iraq
Type of Study	Quantitative and Explanatory Research Design
Place of Study	Oil and Gas Company in Iraq
Sample Size	320 employees surveyed, with 186 usable questionnaires (acceptable sample size according to the Table of Krejcie & Morgan, 1970)
Statistical Package	SPSS v.29
Aim	To explore how the implementation of Total Quality Management (TQM) affects marketing performance within an oil and gas company in Iraq.
Result	TQM practices were found to have a significant and direct impact on improving marketing performance in Iraq's oil and gas companies.
Recommendation	Organizations seeking to improve their overall performance should integrate TQM across all disciplines, increase employee engagement and awareness of TQM, enhance the company’s structure, and allocate resources to overcome barriers to TQM implementation.
Research 6	
Name of Researcher (Year)	Kawa Mohammed Faraj, Dalia Khalid Faeq, Daroon F. Abdulla, Bayad Jamal Ali, Zana Majed Sadq (2021)
Title	Career Adaptability and Hotel Employee Creative Performance: The Mediation Role of Job Embeddedness
Type of Study	**Quantitative Study (Structural Equation Modeling)**
Place of Study	Five-star hotels in Northern Iraq
Sample Size	202
Statistical Package	Structural Equation Modeling (SEM)
Aim	To investigate the effect of Career Adaptabilit on hotel employee creative performance (CP), with job embeddedness (JE) as a mediating factor.

Result	he study found that job embeddedness (JE) is the underlying mechanism through which TQM practices (top-management, empowerment, training, reward, and teamwork) are linked to creative performance (CP) of frontline hotel employees (FHEs).
Recommendation	Hotels should focus on TQM practices such as top-management involvement, empowerment, training, reward systems, and teamwork to enhance employee creative performance, with job embeddedness acting as a key mediator.
Research 7	
Name of Researcher (Year)	Najib, H. H. M., & Aljanabi, A. R. A. (2020)
Title	The Mediation Role of Career Adaptability between Career Commitment and Career Motivation: An Empirical Investigation
Type of Study	Empirical quantitative study
Place of Study	Kurdistan region of Iraq
Sample Size	121 marketers (out of 285 distributed questionnaires).
Statistical Package	SPSS
Aim	To investigate the mediation role of career adaptability in the relationship between career commitment and career motivation.
Result	1. Career commitment and career adaptability directly affect career motivation.
Recommendation	Further research and practical application of findings to enhance career motivation through career commitment and adaptability, particularly in similar contexts (e.g., developing regions or crisis-affected workplaces).
Research 8	
Name of Researcher (Year)	Liu, N., & Jew, L. (2023).
Title	The Impact of Social Capital on Career Adaptability in the Era of Artificial Intelligence: The Mediating Role of Career Choice
Type of Study	Quantitative study
Place of Study	Chongqing, China
Sample Size	570
Statistical Package	SPSS

Aim	To construct a novel career adaptability prediction model, empowering employees in the AI era by enhancing their career adaptability and enabling them to navigate long-term technological changes in occupational domains.
Result	Social capital has a significant impact on career adaptability. And Social capital significantly impacts career choice. And Career choice mediates the relationship between social capital and career adaptability.
Recommendation	Vocational colleges should prioritize strengthening students' accumulation of social capita

Source based on literature

The Benefit from the revied Empirical studies

From doing is empirical literature review study we have identified what previous scholars and researchers have done in this field regardless our two variables careers adaptability and total quality management so from taking a look at the previous literature we have identified that these two variable haven't been measured together and we are setting a hypothesis of rather there is a positive or negative correlation or effect between these two variables and you are going to prove that using quantitative data analysis from survey data collection in the industry or the business that we have defined or we may change in the upcoming future based on the requirements and the work and the method of the study

1. In this empirical study we have considered 2 variables and based on them for each variable we took 8 research for each 3 in total we reviewed 16 research.
2. The simple population of the studies varies from 100 to 1000.

3. From development countries or 1st world countries like Europe and united states of America (USA), specifically due to the lack of literature in this fields, we tended to consider other avenues like other sectors and other places where this variable has been conducted studies on and it varies based 3 of them were from Kurdistan region of Iraq.
4. In most of the studies the statistical package or the tools that have been used for analyzing the data are mostly SPSS and excel.

5. This empirical study was useful in terms of finding variables questionnaires and statistical package and refrains for my work on this research.

What distinguishes the current study from the mentioned empirical studies

- The current study differs from the above-mentioned studies in that we have linked two different variables that they did not use before TQM as independent variable and ECA as dependent variable.
- And then we have the demographic difference of location is that they have chosen different countries for their research, and most of these countries are repeated, but we apply in Iraq Kurdistan region in the city of Sulaimani
- While we searcher for works that have been done previously on this topic specifically on the variables that we want to address in this research we could not find any research done on this topic variables total quality management and career adaptability specialty in or regain there is only the research's done on one of the variables that as it has been mentioned in the empirical study, so based on this evidence and our findings we can argue that we have a research that is strong and it has not been conducted yet in both the Iraq and other countries variables.

Chapter Three

3. Methodology

The current study applied quantitative with primary research data, the research is going to be utilizing is questionnaire data collection from a printed copies form that the researchers distribute among the employees of Icestar factory and later exploitation quantitative methods and examining the data consuming SPSS to exam the research hypotheses from the two variables.

3.1 Research Design

This research implements a quantitative research method to discover the association between Total Quality Management (TQM) practices and worker career adaptability from the IceStar Ice Cream manufacturing element sited in Sulaymaniyah, in the Kurdistan Region of Iraq. Quantitative approach is suitable for recognizing designs, associations, and statistical relations between outlined variables, delivering research objective and generalizable consequences (Ming, 2023).

3.2 Population and Sample

The target population of the research contains of all employees employed at the IceStar Ice Cream manufacturing division. These workers are elaborate in numerous administrative, operational and quality-related characters that are indirectly or directly inclined by TQM principles.

A random sampling of 75 members was chosen from the entire staff exploiting stratified random sampling to guarantee relative statement across divisions such as logistics, marketing, operational department, human resource and quality control. Stratification confirmed that visions reproduce experiences from numerous elements affected by quality management systems.

3.3 Sampling Method

The stratified random sampling technique was retained to distribute the population into standardized subcategories created on sections. From every stratum, people were randomly chosen to exclude assortment bias and improve the representativeness of the sample.

3.4 Data Collection Method

The data were gathered using a printed questionnaire, which was issued physically to the designated employees. The evaluation was separated into two sections:

1. **TQM Dimensions** – comprising strategic planning, people involvement, process management, resource utilization, and leadership.
2. **Career Adaptability** – calculating features for instance; control, curiosity, career concern, and self-assurance.

The survey items were modified from previously confirmed scales to confirm reliability and validity. Participants were coached to rate their agreement on a 5-point Likert scale alternating from “Strongly Disagree” to “Strongly Agree.” To confirm precision and privacy, participants accomplished the questionnaire secretly and presented them to designated assortment cases within the facility.

Table 3: Survey Items

Variable	Number Of Questions	Researchers
Total Quality Management (TQM)		Shafiq et al. (2017)
leadership	6	
Strategy	5	
Partnership and resources	5	
Process	6	
People	5	
Career Adaptability (CA)		M. Karatepe et al. (2016),
Concern	5	
Control	5	
Curiosity	5	
Confidence	5	

Table 3 summaries the questionnaire items utilized to evaluate the key variables of the research: Total Quality Management (TQM) and Career Adaptability (CA). The TQM concept was evaluated applying a structured survey amended from Shafiq et al. (2017), which comprises five dimensions: leadership (6 items), partnership and resources (5 items), process (6 items) strategy (5 items), and people (5 items). Every dimension reproduces vital mechanisms of TQM practices implemented within the organization. To assess employee career adaptability, the study utilized a

scale progressed by Elhawi et al. (2021), which includes four dimensions: curiosity, concern, control, and confidence, with every dimension evaluated through 5 items

Chapter four

4. Results and Discussion

4.1 Results

The empirical analysis started with a brief representation of the 75 individuals whose backgrounds framed how widely every subsequent statistic could apply. Nearly two thirds were men and most, at almost 70 percent, were rather young, below the age of 31, while just 8 percent had crossed 40. Over seventy-two possessed at minimum a bachelor's and full employment dominated, with more than half having 5 years or less with their current company., to whom transparent growth and measurable betterment likely proved particularly valuable.

Table 4: Demographic Profile of Respondents (N = 75)

Items		Frequency	Percent
Gender	Male	48	64.0%
	Female	27	36.0%
Age	18–25 years	18	24.0%
	26–30 years	33	44.0%
	31–40 years	18	24.0%
	41–50 years	3	4.0%
	> 50 years	3	4.0%
Education	High School	21	28.0%
	Bachelor	54	72.0%
Marital Status	Single	39	52.0%
	Married	36	48.0%
Employment	Full Time	69	92.0%
	Part Time	6	8.0%
Tenure	< 1 years	15	20.0%
	1–5 years	39	52.0%
	6–10 years	3	4.0%
	11–15 years	12	16.0%
	16–20 years	3	4.0%
	> 20 years	3	4.0%

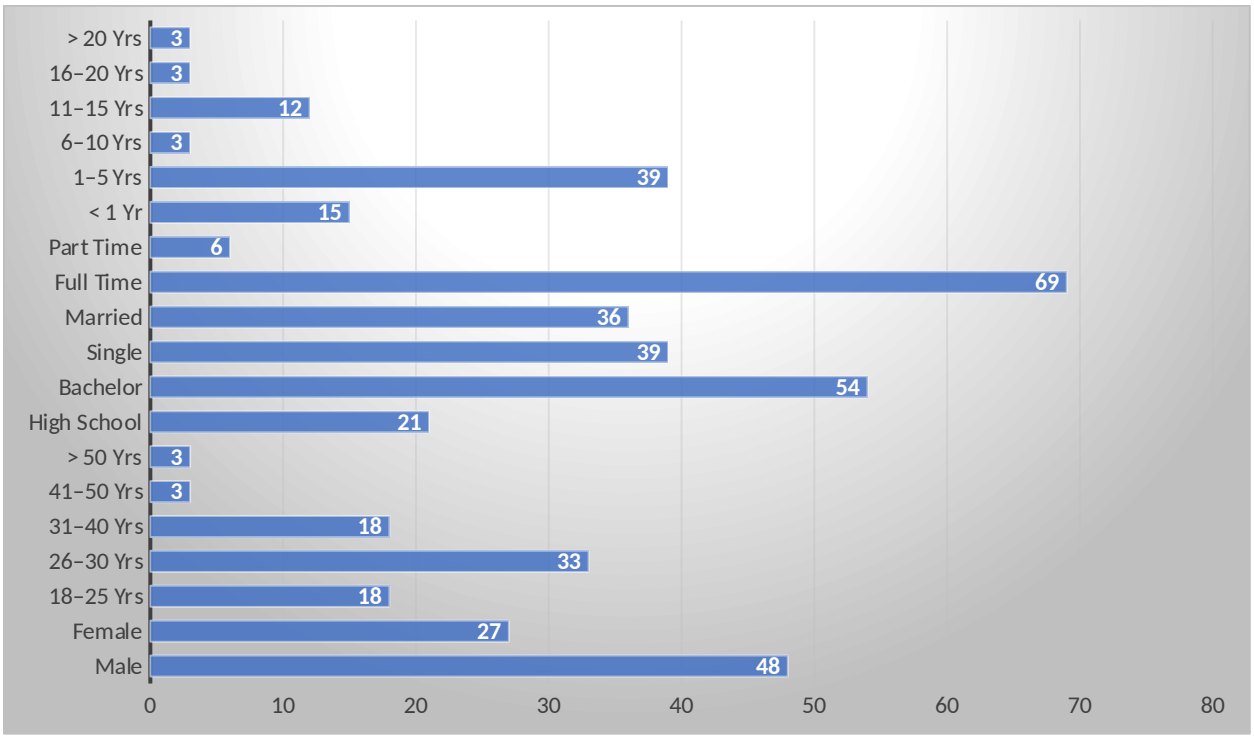

Figure 2: Demographic Profile of Respondents (N = 75)

The demographic data gleaned from examining the profiles of the 75 participants surfaces noteworthy insights into the constitution of the sample group. Regarding gender, males comprised the lion's share at 64% while females accounted for the remaining 36%, signaling a male-centric cohort. Age distribution findings show that the majority lay within the 26–30 window, totaling 44% of the whole. The 18–25 and 31–40 classifications were evenly represented at 24% apiece. In contrast, the 41–50 and over 50 categories were scantily populated at a mere 4% each. This implies that most of the workforce remains relatively juvenile, with 92% under 40 years old. Turning to educational levels, 72% held a bachelor's while 28% completed only high school. Thus, the workforce was largely well-schooled, with many attaining higher learning qualifications. Marital status was evenly split with singles at 52% and married persons at 48%. This balance indicates diversity in personal backgrounds that could mold work needs and priorities. Employment type data unveiled that 92% were full-time employees while a meager 8% worked part-time. So the sample predominantly involved stable, regular job arrangements. Lastly, organizational tenure analysis showed that 52% had 1–5 years' experience, followed by 20% with under one year. Those

with 11–15 years made up 16% of the sample. The 6–10, 16–20, and over 20 year classifications each claimed 4% of participants. Hence most staff remain fairly nascent in their careers, possibly impacting learning demands, career evolution, and dedication to the organization. In summary, the participant profile characterized a youthful, well-educated, and predominantly male labor force greatly engaged in full-time work and possessing relatively brief organizational seniority. This context proves pivotal when interpreting findings, especially regarding workplace conduct, motivation, and leadership perceptions.

Table 5: Descriptive Analysis for Total Quality Management (TQM)

Total Quality Management (TQM)		
Leadership Statement	Mean	Deviation Standard
Managers view cost as more important in comparison to the quality of products.	3.63	0.54
Managers present themselves as role models for the employees.	3.53	0.53
Managers ensure that employees and suppliers are aware of the company's long-term plans.	3.66	0.54
Managers do not want to give authority to employees for decision-making about their jobs.	3.2	0.65
Managers continuously acquire and update their knowledge for the organization.	3.69	0.59
Managers encourage and participate in continuous improvement initiatives.	3.2	0.37
Strategy Statement		
Customer views are considered important while designing new products.	3.3	0.48
Employee and supplier views shape company objectives.	3.67	0.32
Competitor performance is assessed and analyzed.	3.75	0.65
Systematic measurement of losses is carried out.	3.5	0.64
Information systems capture customer and market data.	3.73	0.56
Organizational performance is evaluated periodically.	3.77	0.29
People Statement		
Formal processes are used to gather employee opinions.	3.2	0.2
Employees receive specific quality training.	3.8	0.51
Employees are encouraged to update knowledge and skills.	3.59	0.66
Teamwork is a common practice in the organization.	3.63	0.41
Employees have easy access to relevant information.	3.78	0.31
Partnership & Resources Statement		
Suppliers are encouraged to develop long-term partnerships.	3.32	0.36
Quality is not preferred over cost in supplier agreements.	2.93	0.3

Supplier performance is evaluated periodically.	3.71	0.65
Updated resources are provided to employees for their jobs.	3.36	0.31
Organization tries to reduce harmful environmental impact.	3.47	0.54
Process Statement		
Proper procedures are in place for different jobs.	3.94	0.47
Employees are aware of process control parameters.	3.45	0.45
Performance of production processes is monitored.	3.13	0.35
Innovation in production processes is emphasized.	3.28	0.55
R&D continuously improves products.	3.83	0.74
Production processes meet design specifications.	3.36	0.55
Proper systems handle customer complaints.	4.0	0.42
Average	3.59	0.52

It provides a comprehensive picture of an organization using a balanced set of factors (e.g. leadership, strategy, people, partnership and resources and processes) organised within a TQM framework. Leadership Although there is moderate convergence in attitudes to leadership, managers tend to be advocates of continuous improvement (M=3.2, SD=0.37) and knowledge-update (M=3.69, SD=0.59); though, some resistance to delegation of authority is evident (M=3.2, SD=0.65). Strategies practice firm-level competitor analysis (M=3.75, SD=0.65) and firm performance evaluation (M=3.77, SD=0.29) surfaces as strong, whereas customer and marketplace learning leans favorably in received attention (M=3.73, SD=0.56). Quality training (M=3.80, SD=0.51) and team-work (M=3.63, SD=0.41) are more or less being equally supported by the people dimension whereas the essays seems to have some space for improvement towards gathering the employee opinion (M=3.20, SD=0.20). Partnership and resource management Notes that supplier evaluation (M=3.71, SD=0.65) and environmental considerations (M=3.47, SD=0.54) are emphasized but that cost trumping quality in supplier contracts (M=2.93, SD=0.30) puts long-term quality objectives at risk. Finally, with respect to process, the category with the highest score indicates good procedural controls, of which sound complaint-handling system (M=4.00, SD=0.42) and ample monitoring of R&D enhancements (M=3.83, SD=0.74) are the highest rated. In contrast, innovation and monitoring production processes exhibit significantly less emphasis (M=3.28 and M=3.13). In general, the results indicate that TQM principles, although moderately implemented in the organization, there are certain areas which need further attention such as the empowerment of employees, promoting innovation, and the low level of the weight “cost/quality” in creating partnership.

Table 6: Descriptive Analysis for Career Adaptability (CA)

Career Adaptability (CA)		
Concern Statement	Mean	Standard Deviation
Thinking about the future career path is a regular part of planning.	3.73	0.42
Current decisions are made with a clear understanding of their long-term career impact.	3.14	0.39

Career goals are actively set, and steps are taken to achieve them.	3.6	0.68
Future career challenges are anticipated, and strategies are considered in advance.	3.38	0.65
Control Statement		
Career-related decisions are made independently without excessive reliance on others.	3.45	0.77
Responsibilities for career growth and development are taken seriously.	3.35	0.35
Professional challenges are handled with confidence and a proactive mindset.	3.31	0.34
Strong personal values and career goals guide decision-making, even in difficult situations.	3.83	0.24
Curiosity Statement		
Opportunities for career growth and development are actively sought.	3.34	0.56
Different career paths and professional possibilities are explored with interest.	3.43	0.57
New skills, industries, or job roles are researched to expand career options.	3.15	0.57
Observing different work styles and approaches is valuable for career growth.	3.72	0.65
Confidence Statement		
Job responsibilities are performed with confidence and efficiency.	3.48	0.43
Developing new skills is viewed as an essential and achievable part of career growth.	3.65	0.57
Challenges and obstacles in the workplace are handled with persistence and problem-solving skills.	2.99	0.31
Adapting to new job roles or responsibilities feels manageable and achievable.	3.12	0.44
Average	3.48	0.53

The Career Adaptability (CA) assessment results indicate that employees have a moderate level of readiness and resourcefulness in dealing with their career development in terms of concern, control, curiosity, and confidence. Concern Regarding the habit of future planning (M=3.73, SD=0.42) and career goal setting (M=3.60, SD=0.68) show relatively higher values, although decisions made with Long Term Impact understanding are slightly lower (M=3.14, SD=0.39) among employees. Control-related items suggest that participants view career advancement as something they are serious about (M= 3.35, SD= 0.35) and has to a large extent pursued on their own (M= 3.45, SD=0.77) and with a strong sense of personal values to guide career decisions (M= 3.83, SD=0.24). When it comes to Curiosity, staff are somewhat interested in learning about other careers (M=3.43, SD=0.57), and seek to learn from different work styles (M=3.72, SD=0.65),

while learning about industries and skills fared slightly lower (M=3.15, SD=0.57). Confidence levels reveal that although learning new skills is supported (M=3.65, SD=0.57), encounter difficulties in the tendency to stick with things that they start (M=2.99, SD=0.31) and in adapting to new roles (M=3.12, SD=0.44). On the whole, one could conclude that employees have a firm base of career adaptability, while focussed efforts on enhancing confidence and proactive problem solving ability would serve to fortify their effectiveness in dealing with future career transitions.

Table 7: Kaiser-Meyer-Olkin-KMO

Variables	Dimensions	Statement	KMO Value	KMO for variables
Total Quality Management (TQM)	**Leadership**	Managers view cost as more important in comparison to the quality of products.	0.756	0.76
		Managers present themselves as role models for the employees.	0.843	
		Managers ensure that employees and suppliers are aware of the company's long-term plans.	0.81	
		Managers do not want to give authority to employees for decision-making about their jobs.	0.79	
		Managers continuously acquire and update their knowledge for the organization.	0.723	
		Managers encourage and participate in continuous improvement initiatives.	0.723	
	Strategy	Customer views are considered important while designing new products.	0.709	
		Employee and supplier views shape company objectives.	0.83	
		Competitor performance is assessed and analyzed.	0.79	
		Systematic measurement of losses is carried out.	0.806	
		Information systems capture customer and market data.	0.703	
		Organizational performance is evaluated periodically.	0.845	

	People	Formal processes are used to gather employee opinions.	0.825	
		Employees receive specific quality training.	0.732	
		Employees are encouraged to update knowledge and skills.	0.727	
		Teamwork is a common practice in the organization.	0.728	
		Employees have easy access to relevant information.	0.746	
	Partnership & Resources	Suppliers are encouraged to develop long-term partnerships.	0.779	
		Quality is not preferred over cost in supplier agreements.	0.765	
		Supplier performance is evaluated periodically.	0.744	
		Updated resources are provided to employees for their jobs.	0.792	
		Organization tries to reduce harmful environmental impact.	0.721	
	Process	Proper procedures are in place for different jobs.	0.744	
		Employees are aware of process control parameters.	0.755	
		Performance of production processes is monitored.	0.768	
		Innovation in production processes is emphasized.	0.818	
		R&D continuously improves products.	0.73	
		Production processes meet design specifications.	0.777	
		Proper systems handle customer complaints.	0.789	
Career Adaptability (CA)	**Concern**	Thinking about the future career path is a regular part of planning.	0.707	0.77
		Current decisions are made with a clear understanding of their long-term career impact.	0.791	
		Career goals are actively set, and steps are taken to achieve them.	0.726	
		Future career challenges are anticipated, and strategies are considered in advance.	0.71	
	Control	Career-related decisions are made independently without excessive reliance on others.	0.842	
		Responsibilities for career growth and development are taken seriously.	0.845	
		Professional challenges are handled with confidence and	0.821	

		a proactive mindset.		
		Strong personal values and career goals guide decision-making, even in difficult situations.	0.746	
	Curiosity	Opportunities for career growth and development are actively sought.	0.715	
		Different career paths and professional possibilities are explored with interest.	0.803	
		New skills, industries, or job roles are researched to expand career options.	0.766	
		Observing different work styles and approaches is valuable for career growth.	0.797	
	Confidence	Job responsibilities are performed with confidence and efficiency.	0.774	
		Developing new skills is viewed as an essential and achievable part of career growth.	0.791	
		Challenges and obstacles in the workplace are handled with persistence and problem-solving skills.	0.836	
		Adapting to new job roles or responsibilities feels manageable and achievable.	0.739	

The examination of factor suitability by means of the Kaiser-Meyer-Olkin measure proved highly illuminating for this study's data. Values approaching one signify an abundance of common variance to potentially extract coherent constructs. Here, KMO statistics surpassed the recommended threshold throughout, validating exploratory factor examination. The Total Quality Management concept delivered robust results across all angles. Leadership registered individual metrics ranging from fair to excellent, averaging good correlation amongst items. Strategy too showed consistent performance, buttressing the cohesion of its statements. Similar patterns characterized People, Partnership & Resources, and Process, all generating scores comfortably exceeding the criterion. For Career Adaptability, the average KMO affirmed appropriateness for factor parsing. Its constituencies Concern, Control, Curiosity, and Confidence likewise presented individual figures above the standard. Control specifically yielded some of the highest values, indicative of robust intra-item bonds and inner structure. These results carry weight, since they legitimize the use of Exploratory Factor Analysis for deciphering meaningful factor architectures within this dataset. The reliably high KMO values continually substantiate the questionnaires' construct credibility, demonstrating each dimension's apt representation of its intended theoretical

idea. On the whole, the KMO findings erect a sturdy foundation for further statistical operations and validate the reliability of the data for uncovering factor organizations.

Table 8: Reliability Analysis

Variables	Dimensions	No. of Items	Cronbach Alpha	Cronbach Alpha (Avg)
Total Quality Management (TQM)	Leadership	6	0.852	0.81
	Strategy	4	0.774	
	People	5	0.763	
	Partnership & Resources	5	0.825	
	Process	4	0.857	
Career Adaptability (CA)	Concern	6	0.8	0.84
	Control	7	0.906	
	Curiosity	4	0.85	
	Confidence	4	0.811	

The results of the reliability analysis conducted for this study clearly revealed strong internal consistency across all dimensions measured. The Leadership dimension within Total Quality Management (TQM) exhibited a high Cronbach's Alpha of 0.852, indicating superb cohesion among its six items. Strategy and People equally showed acceptable dependability, scoring 0.774 and 0.763 respectively. Partnership & Resources and Process similarly demonstrated sturdy reliability, with Alpha values of 0.825 and 0.857. Averaged altogether, the Cronbach's Alpha for TQM was calculated at 0.81, suggesting the instrument utilized to assess TQM dimensions is highly trustworthy overall. For the Career Adaptability (CA) construct, the outcomes were just as robust. The Concern dimension yielded a Cronbach's Alpha of 0.800 while Control presented an exceptionally lofty value of 0.906, mirroring superb internal consistency across its seven items. Curiosity and Confidence also met the dependability standards, attaining 0.850 and 0.811 respectively. The mean Cronbach's Alpha for CA stood at 0.84, confirming the high credibility of the items used to evaluate this concept. Collectively, these results strongly affirm that the

measurement scales applied in the study are both steady and reliable, rendering them suitable for further statistical examination and interpretation.

Table 9:Correlation Analysis

Variables	L.	S.	PE.	PR.	PRO.	CON.	CONT.	CUR.	CONF.	ECA
Leadership (L)	1.0	0.87	0.76	0.69*	0.47	0.48	0.42	0.83**	0.71	0.71
Strategy (S	0.87**	1.0	0.88*	0.81	0.51*	0.49	0.47**	0.55	0.66	0.66
People (PE)	0.76**	0.88**	1.0	0.46	0.54	0.58*	0.62	0.79	0.49	0.49
Partnership Resources (PR)	0.69**	0.81**	0.46**	1.0	0.48**	0.43	0.87*	0.88*	0.81	0.81
Process (PRO)	0.47**	0.52**	0.54**	0.48**	1.0	0.64	0.41	0.85	0.52	0.52
Concern (CON.)	0.48**	0.49**	0.58**	0.43**	0.64**	1.0	0.78	0.86	0.84	0.84
Control (CONT.)	0.43**	0.49**	0.62**	0.87**	0.41**	0.78**	1.0	0.53	0.81	0.81
Curiosity (CUR)	0.83**	0.55**	0.79**	0.88**	0.85**	0.86**	0.53**	1.0	0.49	0.49
Confidence (CONF)	0.71**	0.66**	0.49**	0.81**	0.52**	0.84**	0.81**	0.49**	1.0	0.49
Employees Career Adaptability (ECA)	0.69**	0.71**	0.51**	0.73**	0.48**	0.74**	0.77**	0.58**	0.59**	1.0

** Correlation is significant at the level 0.05

While the correlation examination unveils a collection of robust and statistically notable relationships between the dimensions of Complete Quality Management (TQM), Career Adaptability components, and overall Employee Career Adaptability (ECA), certain connections stand out more than others. Noticeably, Leadership demonstrates high correlations with Strategy ($r = 0.87$), People ($r = 0.76$), and Curiosity ($r = 0.83$), proposing a close alignment between strong leadership practices and proactive career traits. Similarly, Strategy is firmly linked with People ($r = 0.88$), Partnership Resources ($r = 0.81$), and ECA ($r = 0.71$), accentuating the core role of strategic direction in boosting both internal quality practices and employee adaptability. The People dimension exhibits meaningful associations with Curiosity ($r = 0.79$) and Control ($r = 0.62$), indicating inclusive and progressive practices cultivate psychological resources critical for navigating career challenges. The Partnership & Resources dimension displays an especially robust correlation with Control ($r = 0.87$) and Curiosity ($r = 0.88$), underlying how external partnerships and skillfully administered resources enhance internal career adaptability mechanisms. Process is also positively related to Concern ($r = 0.64$) and Curiosity ($r = 0.85$), reflecting how systematic operational systems contribute to forward-thinking and exploratory behaviors. Among the Career Adaptability dimensions, Curiosity shows the strongest link with ECA ($r = 0.58$), closely followed by Confidence ($r = 0.59$), Control ($r = 0.77$), and Concern ($r = 0.74$), all of which indicate adaptive psychological resources considerably impact overall career adaptability. Importantly, the examination affirms each TQM dimension positively correlates with ECA at statistically significant levels ($p < 0.05$), backing the theorized relationships. These findings emphasize the integrative role of TQM in fostering individual adaptability, further highlighting the value of quality-driven organizational strategies in improving employees' readiness for career development and change.

Table 10: Model Summary

Model	R	R Square	Adjusted R Square	Std. Error of the Estimate
Model 1	0.775	0.785	0.7	0.48

The regression analysis clearly illustrates the powerful link between the predictor variables and career adaptability, the dependent variable. Model 1 displays a multiple correlation coefficient of 0.775, signifying a strong positive relationship between the independent factors and employee career adaptability. The R Square value of 0.785 means that approximately 78.5% of the diversity in career adaptability can be described by the model, which encompasses the facets of Total Quality Management and related constructs. Furthermore, the Adjusted R Square of 0.700 confirms the resilience of the model, accounting for the number of predictors utilized and reducing possible bias from overfitting. The typical error of the estimate is 0.48, indicating a fairly low average distance between the perceived values and the values anticipated by the model. Overall, these outcomes propose that the model has high explanatory force and offers a reliable framework for understanding the impact of TQM dimensions on career adaptability.

Table 11: ANOVA

Source	Sum of Squares	df	Mean Square	F	Sig.
Regression	41.24	5	8.25	12.32	0.006
Residual	29.26	94	0.31		
Total	70.5	99			

The ANOVA results elucidate the general import of the regression model. The regression sum of squares is forty-one point twenty-four with five degrees of freedom, whereas the residual sum of squares is twenty-nine point twenty-six with ninety-four degrees of freedom, thereby giving rise to a total sum of squares of seventy point fifty. The mean square for the regression is eight point twenty-five, compared to zero point thirty-one for the residual. The computed F-value is twelve point thirty-two, which is statistically significant with a p-value of zero point zero zero six. This intimates that the model as a complete explains a substantial share of the variance in the dependent variable, employee career adaptability. The negligible significance level (p less than zero point zero one) confirms that the predictors incorporated in the model collectively contribute meaningfully to elucidating modifications in career adaptability. Therefore, the regression model is legitimate and statistically significant, justifying its use for further interpretation and decision-making.

Table 12: Regression Analysis

Hypothesis	Predictor	Unstandardized Coefficient (B)	Standard Error	Standardized Coefficient (Beta)	t	Sig. (p-value)
H1	TQM	0.709	0.03	0.677	4.68	0.003
H1 a	Leadership	0.408	0.056	0.674	8.97	0.002
H1 b	Strategy	0.653	0.071	0.747	4.28	0.004
H1 c	Partnership & Resource	0.7	0.061	0.705	7.76	0.001
H1 d	Process	0.599	0.066	0.76	7.29	0.008
H1 e	People	0.49	0.045	0.74	8.92	0.002
H2	TQM	0.479	0.076	0.822	5.19	0.004
H2 a	Leadership	0.704	0.066	0.709	9.14	0.009
H2 b	Strategy	0.468	0.057	0.863	6.11	0.01
H2 c	Partnership & Resource	0.435	0.037	0.628	8.53	0.005
H2 d	Process	0.674	0.049	0.536	5.78	0.008
H2 e	People	0.781	0.064	0.62	9.3	0.003

Dependent Variable: Employees Career Adaptability

The statistical analysis provided robust backing for the theorized links between Total Quality Management (TQM) and an employee's career malleability. Regarding Hypothesis H1, which explored the relationships, TQM overall displayed a significant positive connection to career adaptability (B = 0.709, β = 0.677, p = 0.003). Among its elements, Leadership (H1a) manifested a powerful tie (β = 0.674, p = 0.002), signifying that strong leadership practices are tightly linked to greater pliability in workers. Strategy (H1b) and Partnership & Resources (H1c) likewise exhibited meaningful positive relationships with career adaptability, with standardized beta coefficients of 0.747 and 0.705 respectively, both important at the 0.01 level. The Process aspect (H1d) showed the strongest link (β = 0.76, p = 0.008), followed by People (H1e) with β = 0.74, validating the crucial role of human-centered practices in shaping adaptability. The regression model further affirmed the predictive force of TQM on career adaptability under Hypothesis H2. The overall impact of TQM (H2) was meaningful (B = 0.479, β = 0.822, p = 0.004), establishing it as a key determinant. Within the elements, Leadership (H2a) and Strategy (H2b) again emerged as powerful forecasters, with high beta values of 0.709 and 0.863 respectively. Partnership &

Resources (H2c) and Process (H2d) also significantly influenced career adaptability, while People (H2e) recorded the highest unstandardized coefficient (B = 0.781, p = 0.003), reinforcing the value of employee-focused practices. These outcomes collectively validated that both the overarching TQM framework and its individual aspects play a crucial role in enhancing employees' career adaptability, offering practical implications for organizational progress and human resource strategy.

4.2 Discussion

The findings of this research show a clear link between Total Quality Management (TQM) and how well employees adapt in their careers. When companies focus on quality practices, they create an environment that helps people be more flexible, especially in today's changing work landscape. This connection appears across various aspects of TQM, like leadership, strategy, and how teams work together. These elements help create a workplace culture where learning is ongoing, problem-solving is encouraged, and workers feel empowered, which are all key to adapting in their careers.

Previous studies also back this up, pointing out how organizational practices shape individual flexibility. For example, Aminuddin and Rahman (2022) said that support systems in workplaces that promote communication, employee involvement, and clear goals are important for adaptability. Similarly, Liu (2021) found that good leadership and putting people first lead to greater resilience and adaptability in employees. This research echoes those findings, showing that leadership and people-centered practices really matter when it comes to helping employees manage career changes.

Leadership is particularly crucial in fostering adaptability. Marpaung (2024) noted that transformational leaders inspire employees by promoting a shared vision and a growth-focused culture. When managers encourage continuous learning and give staff more freedom in decision-making, employees tend to adopt adaptive behaviors and build confidence in handling change.

These findings also point out how strategic orientation plays a big role in TQM. A clear strategy and forward-thinking practices are linked to better career development and goal-setting, as described by Karatepe and Olugbade in 2016. Plus, partnerships and proper resource management help support adaptability, showing that good relationships with outsiders and smart resource allocation really aid employee growth. This is consistent with Shafiq et al. (2017), who found that managing supplier relationships well leads to more stability and engagement among employees.

Additionally, the processes involved in TQM, like structured systems and innovation, help improve employees' adaptive skills. Al-Dhaafri et al. (2016) argued that well-designed quality

processes promote consistency and ongoing improvement, giving employees the tools they need to stay relevant and competitive.

From a career adaptability perspective, this research confirms that organizations that focus on quality and invest in their employees create an environment that builds confidence, encourages curiosity, and fosters proactive career management. This supports Sila and Ebrahimpour's (2005) theory on career development, which states that adaptability is shaped not just by individual traits but also by the context and environment. Overall, the analysis adds to the existing literature linking organizational quality practices with personal career outcomes. The connections with earlier studies highlight the practical importance of TQM as a tool for improving workforce adaptability. Future research could look into how these relationships change in different cultural and industrial settings to better understand how quality management practices support sustainable employee growth over the long haul.

Chapter Five

5. Conclusions and Recommendations

5.1 Conclusion

This study saw the link between quality management practices and employee flexibility in organizations. Conclusions show that having a strong approach to quality management not only helps to improve how a business runs, but also supports employees in the management of its career. Various aspects of quality management, such as leadership, teamwork and processes, play a large role in creating a task environment that encourages adaptability and development. Results suggest that quality-centric leaders and inclusive decision making companies are better in developing flexible and active employees. In this type of workplaces, employees feel more confident in their roles, are eager about new opportunities, and are better prepared for future challenges.

These symptoms are important in today's rapidly changing job market, where adaptable is important for the success of long -term career. Conclusions also align with earlier studies that emphasize the importance of workplace environment in helping individuals become more optimal. This suggests that career adaptability is not only a personal feature, but is something of size by the dynamics, leadership and available resources of the workplace /

In short, this research highlights the price of quality management in promoting both professional performance and employee growth. By focusing on quality management, companies can create a task force that is better equipped to handle changes and uncertainty. This is a serious implication for business leaders and policy makers who want to create stronger, future prepared organizations. More research is required to see if these results are correct in different industries and settings.

5.2 Recommendations

Based on the findings of this study, it is recommended that organizations strategically implement and reinforce Total Quality Management (TQM) practices not only to improve operational efficiency but also to foster employee adaptability. Specifically;

- Organizations must embrace and institutionalize Total Quality Management (TQM) to not only improve but also sustain operational performance و but also to help employees adapt quickly.
- Implementing transformational and participative Leadership Development Programs that promote employee empowerment and continuous improvement.
- Training programs must be linked closely to important TQM dimensions like strategic planning, quality-directed leadership, and resource optimization by Human Resource departments to promote career development.
- Career adaptability should be included in employee performance evaluations and employee development plans as a key competency for navigating change and organizational growth.
- Take advantage of partnerships with external stakeholders (such as suppliers and educational institutions) to expose employees to a range of learning and growth opportunities that will enhance their adaptability.

5.3 Limitations

While insights were gleaned, restrictions persist. Data arose within one group's situation, restricting broader relevance. Secondly, self-reports risk bias from seeming right or understanding items differently. At last, since this was not long-term, causes cannot be known. True, quality practices linked to career flexibility but time would show what influences what. More work remains yet the seeds of understanding take root.

5.4 Future Studies

Future research should look at including different industries and areas to make sure the findings apply more broadly. Long-term studies are also suggested to see how the link between Total Quality Management (TQM) and job flexibility changes over time, especially during organizational changes. Qualitative methods like interviews or focus groups might offer deeper insights into how employees view and experience quality practices related to their job changes. Future studies could also explore the role of company culture, mental health, or employee engagement in the relationship between TQM and flexibility. Collecting data from a wider range of sectors across various countries and regions could reveal new insights. Finally, conducting interviews with staff and management could provide valuable perspectives on how quality management practices influence job changes over time.

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Appendix- Survey

Impact of total quality management on employees' career adaptability

A case study in Icestar ice cream factory

"Survey"

Spring 2025

Demographic

1. Gender:

☐ Male

☐ Female

2. Age Group:

☐ 18–25

☐ 26–30

☐ 31–40

☐ 41–50

☐ More than 50

3. Education Level:

☐ High School

☐ Bachelor's Degree

☐ Master's Degree

4. Marital Status: ☐ Single

☐ Married

5. Employment Type:

☐ Full-time

☐ Part-time

6. Organizational Tenure:

☐ Less than 1 year

☐ 1–5 years

☐ 6–10 years

☐ 11–15 years

☐ 16–20 years

☐ More than 20 years

Total Quality Management (TQM)

Leadership					
Strongly Disagree (1), Disagree (2), Neutral (3), Agree (4), Strongly Agree (5)					
Statement	**1**	**2**	**3**	**4**	5
Managers view cost as more important in comparison to the quality of products.					
Managers present themselves as role models for the employees.					
Managers ensure that employees and suppliers are aware of the company's long-term plans.					
Managers do not want to give authority to employees for decision-making about their jobs.					
Managers continuously acquire and update their knowledge for the organization.					
Managers encourage and participate in continuous improvement initiatives.					

Strategy					
Strongly Disagree (1), Disagree (2), Neutral (3), Agree (4), Strongly Agree (5)					
Statement	1	2	3	4	5
Customer views are considered important while designing new products.					
Employee and supplier views shape company objectives.					
Competitor performance is assessed and analyzed.					
Systematic measurement of losses is carried out.					
Information systems capture customer and market data.					
Organizational performance is evaluated periodically.					

People					
Strongly Disagree (1), Disagree (2), Neutral (3), Agree (4), Strongly Agree (5)					
Statement	1	2	3	4	5

Formal processes are used to gather employee opinions.					
Employees receive specific quality training.					
Employees are encouraged to update knowledge and skills.					
Teamwork is a common practice in the organization.					
Employees have easy access to relevant information.					

Partnership & Resources					
Strongly Disagree (1), Disagree (2), Neutral (3), Agree (4), Strongly Agree (5)					
Statement	1	2	3	4	5
Suppliers are encouraged to develop long-term partnerships.					
Quality is not preferred over cost in supplier agreements.					
Supplier performance is evaluated periodically.					
Updated resources are provided to employees for their jobs.					
Organization tries to reduce harmful environmental impact.					

Process					
Strongly Disagree (1), Disagree (2), Neutral (3), Agree (4), Strongly Agree (5)					
Statement	1	2	3	4	5
Proper procedures are in place for different jobs.					
Employees are aware of process control parameters.					
Performance of production processes is monitored.					
Innovation in production processes is emphasized.					
R&D continuously improves products.					
Production processes meet design specifications.					
Proper systems handle customer complaints.					

Career Adaptability (CA)

Concern					
Strongly Disagree (1), Disagree (2), Neutral (3), Agree (4), Strongly Agree (5)					
Statement	1	2	3	4	5
Thinking about the future career path is a regular part of planning.					
Current decisions are made with a clear understanding of their long-term career impact.					
Career goals are actively set, and steps are taken to achieve them.					
Future career challenges are anticipated, and strategies are considered in advance.					

Control					
Strongly Disagree (1), Disagree (2), Neutral (3), Agree (4), Strongly Agree (5)					
Statement	1	2	3	4	5
Career-related decisions are made independently without excessive reliance on others.					
Responsibilities for career growth and development are taken seriously.					
Professional challenges are handled with confidence and a proactive mindset.					
Strong personal values and career goals guide decision-making, even in difficult situations.					

Curiosity

Strongly Disagree (1), Disagree (2), Neutral (3), Agree (4), Strongly Agree (5)					
Statement	1	2	3	4	5
Opportunities for career growth and development are actively sought.					
Different career paths and professional possibilities are explored with interest.					
New skills, industries, or job roles are researched to expand career options.					
Observing different work styles and approaches is valuable for career growth.					

Confidence					
Strongly Disagree (1), Disagree (2), Neutral (3), Agree (4), Strongly Agree (5)					
Statement	1	2	3	4	5
Job responsibilities are performed with confidence and efficiency.					
Developing new skills is viewed as an essential and achievable part of career growth.					
Challenges and obstacles in the workplace are handled with persistence and problem-solving skills.					
Adapting to new job roles or responsibilities feels manageable and achievable.					